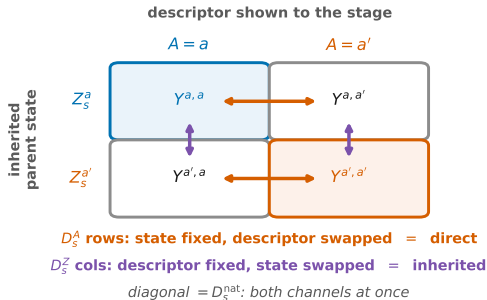


Holding the inherited state fixed separates a stage that reads the descriptor from one that only inherits its effect

(a) the crossover $Y_S^{i,j} = \phi_S(f_S(Z_S^i, A = j))$



(b) one scenario, fault planted at Elicit

ELICIT	D^{nat}		0.33	DIRECT!
	D^A		0.33	
	D^Z		0.00	
RETRIEVE	D^{nat}		0.20	INHERITED!
	D^A		0.00	
	D^Z		0.20	
RANK	D^{nat}		0.75	INHERITED!
	D^A		0.00	
	D^Z		0.75	
EXPLAIN	D^{nat}		0.50	INHERITED!
	D^A		0.00	
	D^Z		0.50	
MEMORY	D^{nat}		0.33	INHERITED!
	D^A		0.00	
	D^Z		0.33	

Elicit adds an unsupported preference on the $A = a$ arm. Four later stages diverge; none of them reads A .

Only Elicit has $D_S^A > 0$, so only Elicit is implicated. Repairing it and rerunning descendants removes 0.58 of the final ranking gap against 0.17 for a stage the crossover exonerates; localization recovers the planted stage in 48/48 scenarios. The planted fault is a unit test of the instrument, not a claim about group preferences.